

Highlights

Certification without a safety dividend: forgeable credentials in populations of autonomous agents

- Badged and unbadged faces carry the same replicator flow, up to the dues
- A settled certified market is no safer, only poorer by exactly its dues
- Mimics hollow out a credential before conduct degrades, so monitors see nothing
- Safety is set by assortment alone and credential integrity by verification alone
- Exclusion is a dial: a small entry toll buys most of the forgery tolerance